“The past is gone:

Learn from it.

The future is ahead:

Prepare for it.

The present is here:

Live it!”

Thomas S. Monson

“É expressamente probido a cópia, reprodução, difusão, transmissão, utilização por terceiros, modificação, venda, publicação, distribuição ou qualquer outro uso, na totalidade ou em parte, em qualquer tipo de suporte, sem prévia autorização por escrito do autor deste material.”
Dúvidas, sugestões ou informações pelo email: jacoseid@gmail.com **ou whats app: (35) 9672- 1111**

Lesson 01

LEARN IT

1. to keep out

Definition: to stay outside of something or somewhere, not to go in.

Example: *The sign in front of the factory said, "Keep Out!"*

2. to keep off

Definition: to stay off of something or not to walk on something, stay away from something.

Example: *The school teacher told the kids to keep off the grass.*

3. it's up to

Definition: it's your decision, you have to decide.

Example: *It's up to the teacher to decide what time the class will start.*

4. off and on

Definition: sometimes, not always, occasionally.

Example: *We go to the club to play tennis off and on.*

5. to get through

Definition: to complete or finish

Example: *I got through watching the movie at about 1:00 a.m.*

6. to look into

Definition: to study or examine something very carefully.

Example: *The lawyer promised me that he'd look into the case this week.*

7. to keep track of

Definition: to be very organized and to keep a record of all the details.

Example: He has so many bills to pay that it's almost impossible to keep track of all of them.

8. <u>to take turns</u>

Definition: to alternate, usually involving people and or games.

Example: We take turns doing the dishes at home.

9. <u>to be about to</u>

Definition: almost ready or prepared, on the point of

Example: I was just about to call you when you got here.

10. <u>over and over</u>

Definition: repeatedly, many times, again and again.

Example: He read the report over and over because he didn't want to forget anything.

<u>USE IT</u>

1. What time did you ***get through*** with your activity last night?

2. Do you go to the movies every Saturday night or just ***off and on***?

3. How do you ***keep track*** of all your bills?

4. Is it ***up to*** *you* or to your parents to decide where you will study?

5. Why are there so many signs near the Police Station that say, ***"Keep Out"***?

6. Why did the teacher tell the children to ***keep off*** the grass?

7. What did she mean when she said, "I'm not sure but I will ***look into it***."?

8. Why did she tell him ***over and over*** to stop biting his fingernails?

9. What were you ***about to*** do when the phone rang yesterday?

10. Do you ***take turns*** washing the dishes at home?

Lesson 02

A PRETTY SMART IDEA

Robby was playing soccer in the street with his friends, but instead of making a goal he broke the neighbor's front window. That's right! He kicked the ball so hard that it broke the neighbor's front window. Of course, all the kids got a little bit worried, however, none of them were quite as scared as Robert, after all, he was the one who kicked the ball. Well, within a few minutes most of the kids had run home, which left Robert all alone to talk to the neighbor. Now, Robby was a pretty smart kid and he had a pretty smart idea. This was the plan: Since the Smiths were new in the neighborhood and didn't know Robby and his parents, he decided to go to the neighbor's house to get the ball. Mrs. Smith was obviously a little upset, but she quickly agreed to give the ball to Robby when he told her that his father would come by at 5:00 sharp that afternoon to fix their window. Well, just as Robby said, at 5:00 sharp Mr. Jones showed up at the Smith's house and fixed their window. After fixing their window, Mr. Jones presented Mrs. Smith with a bill for $125.00 for the job. Mrs. Smith couldn't believe it and said, "Wait a minute, aren't you the little boy's father? Well, Mr. Jones was just as surprised as she was and said, "No! Aren't you his mother?"

What's the answer?

1. What happened when Robby kicked the ball?
2. What did the other kids do after Robby kicked the ball?
3. What did Robby tell Mrs. Smith?
4. Why was Mrs. Smith so surprised when she got the bill?
5. Why was Mr. Jones also surprised?

USE IT

instead of agreed worried fix

Lesson 03

BOYS OR GIRLS

An old man was sitting on a park bench in Central Park one Sunday morning watching the kids and feeding the pigeons when someone sat down beside him. **"How do you do?"** the old man said to the person. **"I couldn't be better"**, the person replied. The old man loved to meet new people and to make new friends. After a few minutes the old man said, **"This world is really changing, you know, it sure is hard to tell boys from girls nowadays, I mean, it's almost impossible to tell if a person is a boy or a girl."** His new friend sat quietly on the bench listening to the old man as he said, "**Today boys and girls are wearing earrings, long hair and jeans."** The old man continued**, "For example, do you see that young person sitting on the other side of the park?" "Yes, of course"**, his friend replied. **"Well, is that person a boy or a girl?"** the old man asked his friend. Immediately his friend answered, **"That's easy, she's a girl and she's also my daughter!"** All of a sudden the old man turned red and said, **"I'm so sorry, I really didn't know that you were her mother!" "I'm not! I'm her father,"** the friend answered.

What's the answer?

1. What did the old man say about boys and girls nowadays?
2. How are boys and girls dressing today?
3. Who was sitting on the other side of the park?
4. Why did the old man turn red?
5. Who was the person sitting next to the old man?

USE IT

replied all of sudden earrings turned red

Lesson 04

LEARN IT

1. up to date

Definition: modern, used nowadays

Example: This manual is not very up to date, it was written almost ten years ago.

2. out of date

Definition: old, not in use or current, not available anymore.

Example: Black and white movies have been out of date for more than fifty years.

3. to do over

Definition: to repeat or do it once more.

Example: My manager told me I had to do the report over because it was so messy.

4. to burn down

Definition: to burn to the ground, usually refers to some kind of house or building.

Example: Their house burned down almost one year after they finished building it.

5. to take something for granted

Definition: to believe without proof or evidence, no appreciation for something

Example: He spoke English so well that I just took it for granted that he was an American.

6. as to

Definition: concerning or talking about

Example: As to the time of their arrival in Chicago, we really don't have any idea.

7. <u>To feel sorry for</u>

<u>Definition</u>: to feel compassion or pity for someone

Example: I feel sorry for them because their little son was hurt in the accident.

8. <u>to have a good time</u>

<u>Definition</u>: to have a lot of fun, to enjoy yourself.

<u>Example</u>: They really had a good time at Disneyland last Summer.

9. <u>to be in charge of</u>

<u>Definition</u>: to be responsible for something, the leader of the group.

<u>Example</u>: Who is in charge of this company while the president is traveling?

10. <u>to figure out</u>

<u>Definition</u>: to make an effort to understand something, to make sense of it.

<u>Example</u>: I really can't figure out why she lives in Los Angeles if she works in Newport.

<u>USE IT</u>

1. Why did you ***take it for granted*** that she was from London?
2. Why did the teacher ask you to do the exercises ***over***?
3. Why are the computers at school considered ***out of date***?
4. How did the Shopping Center ***burn down***?
5. Can you ***figure out*** why the manager decided to close the restaurant after the soccer game?
6. Who is ***in charge of*** the country when the president is traveling?
7. When was the last time that you had a ***good time***?
8. Tell me about someone that you ***feel sorry for***?
9. ***As to*** the World Cup of Soccer, who are the favorites?
10. Is your computer ***up to date***?

Lesson 5

WINSTON CHURCHILL

Many years ago in England there lived a small boy by the name of Winston Churchill. Like most other little five year old boys, Winston liked to run and play. However, one day while playing in the garden behind his family's home, little Winston fell in the lake behind the house and almost drowned. Fortunately, the gardener was working nearby and heard the little boy's scream for help. At once, the gardener ran to the lake, jumped into the lake and saved the boy's life. Winston's family was so grateful that they insisted on rewarding the gardener for having saved their son's life. The gardener, however, refused their offer. Nevertheless, they continued to insist on paying the gardener for his heroic deed. The gardener then replied, **"if you must pay, then pay for my son's education, you see, my son would like to study medicine and to become a doctor."** From that day forward, Winston's family began paying for the gardener's son's education. Nearly fifty years later, Winston was elected Prime Minister. These were difficult times as England and the other allied nations were involved in World War II. At this time Adolph Hitler and his Third Reich were threatening world peace. Winston in the meantime became very sick with pneumonia and almost died. The government soon called Sir Alexander Fleming, who was very much involved in research and had recently discovered a cure for pneumonia: **penicillin!.** Dr. Fleming and penicillin saved Winston Churchill's life. What makes this story interesting is the fact that Sir Alexander Fleming was the gardener's son!

What's the answer?

1. What happened while Winston was playing near the lake?
2. How did the gardener know that Winston had fallen in the lake?
3. Why did Winston's family want to reward the gardener?
4. What was the gardener's suggestion?
5. Who saved Winston's life fifty years later? How?

USE IT : grateful threatening insist discovered

Lesson 06

THE SHOE FACTORY

Ken Taylor was the president of a large and very profitable shoe factory in Riverside, California. One day, while participating in a meeting with several managers to discuss last year's sales, Mr. Taylor stood up to make a point and to test his managers' vision. He said to the first manager, **"I'd like to open a new factory in Africa and I'd like to know what you think about my idea! Without hesitating the manager answered, "Nobody wears shoes in Africa!"**The manager insisted and asked the second manager how he felt about the idea. The second manager answered with as much conviction as the first, **"Nobody wears shoes in Africa!"** However, when Mr. Taylor asked the third manager, he stood up and answered confidently, **"Let's open the new shoe factory in Africa today, because nobody wears shoes in Africa and I believe that we can sell millions of shoes there**." As you can see, all three managers answered the same question with the same answer; however, the first and second managers were pessimists, while the third manager was an optimist and possessed that special ability to see the opportunity.

What's the answer?

1. Who was Ken Taylor?
2. What do you know about his factory in Riverside?
3. What did the first and second salesmen say about Africa?
4. Why did the last salesman want to open the factory immediately?
5. What kind of person is an optimist?

USE IT

profitable hesitate vision optimist

Lesson 07

LEARN IT

1. (to break down)

Definition: to stop functioning, motors etc...

Example: My car broke down yesterday while I was driving to the airport.

2. (to turn out)

Definition: the final results, to eventually become.

Example: I thought that it was going to rain but it turned out to be a sunny day.

3. (to give up)

Definition: to surrender or stop trying.

Example: Our boss tried to give up smoking at least ten times.

4. (to cross out)

Definition: to cancel, usually with a pencil or pen etc...

Example: My name was on the list last week but somebody crossed it out.

5. (to count on)

Definition: to depend on something or someone.

Example: They are counting on you to pick them up at the airport at 7:00 p.m...

6. (to make friends)

Definition: to acquire new and more friends

Example: Patty is a little shy and that's why she doesn't make friends very easily.

7. (out of order)

Definition: temporarily not in working condition, usually equipment or machines.

Example: I couldn't call you from the school because the telephone there was out of order.

8. (to go with)

Definition: usually refers to two young people going out together, dating.

Example: How long have you been going with your girlfriend?

9. (on purpose)

Definition: intentionally, purposely or with intent.

Example: Did he really hit you on purpose?

10. (to take place)

Definition: to happen or occur, usually refers to a meeting, convention, party etc...

Example: The annual convention will take place in March this year.

USE IT

1. How long have Daniel and Janet been ***going with*** each other?

2. Is it possible that someone would hit another car ***on purpose***?

3. Where did your last birthday party ***take place***?

4. What will you do if the school computer is ***out of order***?

5. Do you think it's easy ***to make friends*** at your school or job?

6. Why do you think that the teacher ***crossed out*** Lisa's name?

7. Why do some people ***give up*** more than others?

8. How is this year ***turning out*** for you?

9. Why do cars sometimes ***break down*** on highways?

10. Who do you ***count on*** when you need to talk or you have a problem?

Lesson 08

THE AMERICAN ECONOMY

A famous American economist was once asked to explain the American economy to a group of international diplomats while they were visiting Washington D.C. All of the visitors were quite interested in learning what made the American economy different than other economies. They were interested in learning how the U.S.A. was able to maintain their inflation rate so low for so many years and how the country was able to sustain growth over the years.

The economist attempted to explain, **"My friends, to explain the American economy is not an easy task, however, I'd like to compare it to the beetle. You see, if you consider the beetle's size, its weight and its wings, the beetle isn't supposed to fly. In other words, scientifically speaking the beetle can't fly. However, just the opposite is true, the beetle flies! Now, if you consider the size of the American economy, its debt, its trade deficit and all its many problems, everything seems to indicate that the American economy isn't suppose to fly. However, like the beetle, the American economy continues to fly"**.

What's the answer?

1. What was the economist explaining?
2. What did the visitors want to know?
3. What did the economist compare the U.S. economy to?
4. Why is the beetle similar to the U.S. economy?
5. What do you think about the American economy?

USE IT

economist task Rate debt

Lesson 09

FALLING IN THE LAKE

Daniel lived in the country and loved to play with his animals, but he especially liked to play in a small lake behind their farm. When Daniel heard that his parents were thinking about selling their farm and moving to New York City he was afraid that he'd never play in the lake again. Unfortunately, for Daniel the day finally arrived and he had to say good-bye to his dogs and to the lake where he swam. A few days after arriving in New York, he asked a neighbor if there were any lakes in New York. His neighbor told him that there was a small lake in Central Park. Saturday morning Daniel got up early and walked to Central Park to visit the lake. When he got to the lake he saw a large sign in front of the lake that said, **"WARNING: THIS LAKE IS DANGEROUS, MORE THAN 100 PEOPLE HAVE FALLEN INTO IT."** Daniel immediately looked in the lake and said, **"I can't see anybody!"**

What's the answer?

1. What did Daniel like to do at the farm?
2. Why was he worried about living in New York?
3. Why did Daniel go to Central Park when he arrived in New York?
4. What did the sign say in front of the lake?
5. Why was Daniel so surprised?

USE IT

afraid got few warning

Lesson 10

LEARN IT

1. (to look after)

Definition: to take care of something or someone, to watch carefully.

Example: Who is going to look after your kids while you're on vacation?

2. (to feel like)

Definition: to have a strong desire to do something, really want to do something.

Example: Do you feel like going to the movies tonight?

3. (once and for all)

Definition: the last time, finally or definitively.

Example: I told him once and for all that I wouldn't go to the dance with him.

4. (to hear from)

Definition: to receive a message from someone or to receive information.

Example: Have you heard from your relatives in Los Angeles lately?

5. (to hear of)

Definition: to know something about someone or something, it was mentioned.

Example: Have you heard of Robert Frost?

6. (to make fun of)

Definition: to laugh at someone or make jokes about someone.

Example: The children are always making fun of Betty because she's short.

7. (to come true)

Definition: to really happen, to be true, usually dreams and wishes.

Example: Everyone said that he'd be a doctor one day and it came true.

8. (as a matter of fact)

Definition: really, it's a fact; there is no question about it.

Example: He thinks that he speaks French very well but, as a matter of fact, he doesn't.

9. (to look forward to)

Definition: to wait for something, to anticipate it with pleasure.

Example: I'm looking forward to hearing from you in the near future.

10. (to keep on)

Definition: to continue doing something without stopping.

Example: Do you plan to keep on studying at the University of California in Riverside?

USE IT

1. Who ***looks after*** your house and things while you travel?
2. What do you ***feel like*** drinking when it's hot outside?
3. What would you like to study ***once and for all***?
4. Have you ***heard from*** your relatives recently?
5. Have you ever ***heard of*** La Jolla?
6. Why do kids always ***make fun of*** other kids?
7. Do dreams always ***come true***?
8. ***As a matter of fact*** I am left handed, what about you?
9. Tell me about something you are ***looking forward to***?
10. Why do so many people ***keep on*** smoking if it's bad for their health?

Lesson 11

NO BATHS

Mike was eight years old and loved to play outside with his friends. However, he hated to take a bath. Three or four times a day his mother said to him, “Mike, your hands are dirty again! Please go wash your hands.” But Mike never washed his hands very well and he was always very dirty.

One day Mike’s aunt and uncle came to visit for the weekend and they brought their little son Tyler. Tyler was one year younger than Mike, and he didn’t like to take a bath either. So, the little boys played in the mud all day long. Of course, their parents told them to wash up but they were so busy playing that they didn’t pay any attention to their parents. Finally, after playing all day in the mud, the boys sat down to rest on the porch in front of the house. Mike looked at Tyler’s hands and proudly said, “My hands are dirtier than yours!” “Well, of course they are”, Tyler answered. “You’re one year older than I am.”

What’s the answer?

1. What did Mike hate to do?
2. What did Mike’s mother tell him every day?
3. Who came to visit and to play with Mike?
4. What do you know about Mike’s cousin?
5. What did Mike and Tyler talk about on the porch?

USE IT

hated mud dirty busy

Lesson 12

OUR NEW PORSCHE

Steve lived in a small suburb just outside of New York City. Eventually, he received a promotion and moved with his family to New York. One day while washing his new red Porsche in front of his house, one of Steve's new neighbors looked out the window and said, "Wow, is that your new car? "Sometimes," Steve answered. His neighbor was really surprised. "Sometimes?" he said. "What do you mean?"

"Well," answered Steve, "when there is a party, it belongs to my daughter, Julie. When there's a football game it belongs to my son, David. After I wash it, and it looks really nice and clean, it belongs to my wife. And when it needs gas, it's mine."

What's the answer?

1. What was Steve doing on Saturday?
2. What did his neighbor ask?
3. What did Steve say about his daughter and his son?
4. What did Steve say about his wife?
5. When is the car Steve's?

USE IT

promotion mean wow belongs

Lesson 13

1. (inside out)
Definition: not correct, in the reverse position, the inner side turned toward the outside.
Example: I don't know why he put on his t-shirt inside out.
2. (upside down)
Definition: not correct, in the reverse position, the top is turned to the bottom.
Example: Was the car upside down after the accident?
3. (to fill out)
Definition: to complete a form or an application, with a pen, pencil or on a computer.
Example: How long did it take you to fill out the application to study at Harvard?
4. (at first)
Definition: originally, in the beginning.
Example: At first I thought that English was really hard, but later I discovered it wasn't.
5. (to find out)
Definition: to learn new information or to discover some interesting facts.
Example: I called the airport to find out what time her plane landed.
6. (right away)
Definition: immediately, right now or as soon as possible.
Example: I'd like to speak with you right away about your rent.
7. (little by little)
Definition: very slowly, gradually, but progressively.

Example: If I study English every week my vocabulary will increase little by little.

8. (never mind)

Definition: not to worry about something, not pay any attention to it or forget it.

Example: Robert tried to return the money he owed me but I said, "Never mind!"

9. (to talk over)

Definition: to discuss a subject or a problem.

Example: My parents always taught me to talk over my problems and not to argue.

10. (to make no difference)

Definition: it's not a problem; either way is fine and O.K...

Example: It makes no difference to me if you're a Republican or a Democrat.

USE IT

1. Have you ever seen a teenager wear his/her T- shirt ***inside out***?
2. Why is the shampoo ***upside down*** in the bathroom?
3. How long does it take you ***to fill out*** the forms to open a Checking Account at the bank?
4. Why do so many people think that English is difficult ***at first***?
5. What's the fastest way ***to find a*** telephone number?
6. Why did the manager tell his secretary that he needed the letter right ***away***?
7. Is your English improving ***little by little***? If so, why?
8. Why do you think that the teacher said, ***"never mind"*** when I offered to help her?
9. Why is it a good idea to ***talk over*** your problems and not to argue?
10. Does it ***make any difference*** to you if you study at night or in the morning?

Lesson 14

HE LOOKS LIKE A MONKEY

Mr. and Mrs. Gordon got married when he was twenty one, and she was nineteen. Twenty five years later they decided to have a big party to celebrate their wedding anniversary. They also decided to take some photographs.

After the party, the photographer gave Mrs. Gordon his card and said, **"Your photographs will be ready next Friday and you can pick them up at the studio." "No,"** Mrs. Gordon said, **"please send them to us."** The photographs arrived in the mail a week later, but Mrs. Gordon was very upset when she saw the pictures. She immediately got into her car and drove to the studio to speak with the manager. She went inside and said**, "Do you remember the photographs you took last week at our anniversary?" "Of course,"** the photographer answered. **"What's the problem?" "Well, my husband looks like a monkey in this photo!"** she answered. "**Wait a minute! That's not my fault."**The photographer answered, **"Why didn't you think of that before you married him?"**

What's the answer?

1. How old were Mr. and Mrs. Gordon when they got married?
2. What were they going to celebrate?
3. Why was Mrs. Gordon very upset when she received the photos?
4. What did she decide to do when she received the photos?
5. What did the photographer say to Mrs. Gordon?

USE IT

wedding upset mail looks like

Lesson 15

LOOKING FOR A HOTEL

Dan Carlson was traveling around the country in his car. One evening he was driving along a country road in Oklahoma looking for a small hotel where he could spend the night. Suddenly, he saw an old man at the side of the road. He stopped his car and asked the old man if he knew where he could find a nice hotel. **"Of course,"** the old man answered. **"I can show you the way."** He got into Dan's car, and they drove for almost twelve miles. When they came to a small house the old man said**, "Stop right here."** Dan stopped and looked at the house. **"But this isn't a hotel,"** he said to the old man.

"No," the old man answered, **"this is my house. Now I'll show you the way to the Sunset Hotel. Turn around and go back seven miles and you will see the Sunset Hotel on your left."**

What's the answer?

1. Where was Dan traveling?
2. What was he looking for?
3. What did the old man say to Dan?
4. Where did the old man take Dan?
5. Where was the hotel?

USE IT

along way miles turn around

Lesson 16

LEARN IT

1. (to tear off, to break off)

Definition: to separate, to remove with a little force.

Example: He tore off a small piece of paper and wrote down his address.

2. (to tell /two different things/apart)

Definition: to distinguish between two different things.

Example: He looks like his brother and nobody can tell them apart.

3. (to take charge of)

Definition: to be a leader or the one responsible.

Example: Somebody needs to take charge of the arrangements for the wedding.

4. (to go around)

Definition: to have sufficient for everyone.

Example: There are a lot of cookies in the kitchen but not enough to go around.

5. *(to be in the way)*

Definition: to block or obstruct, causing some confusion.

Example: I know how much he wanted to help us but he was in the way.

6. (in vain)

Definition: useless or without any positive results.

Example: All of the doctor's exams were in vain and the patient soon died.

7. (to put up with)

Definition: to be very patient and to hold your tongue or tolerate.

Example: I tried to put up with my boss but it was almost impossible.

8. (to put on weight)

Definition: to gain weight slowly or to get heavier.

Example: I couldn't recognize her because she put on so much weight.

9. (to show off)

Definition: to display or exhibit your talents in front of others.

Example: Mary plays tennis very well but she likes to show off in front of everyone.

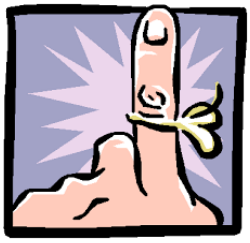
10. (day in and day out)

Definition: always, continuously or without stopping.

Example: Day in and day out she arrived late at work.

USE IT

1. Who ***tore off*** the calendar?
2. Can you ***tell*** two twins apart?
3. Who will ***take charge of*** the hotel reservations?
4. Are there always enough chairs ***to go around***?
5. When are children usually ***in the way***?
6. Have you ever done something ***in vain***? What?
7. Who do you have ***to put up*** **with** sometimes?
8. Who do you know that is ***putting on weight***? Why?
9. Why do people like to ***show off***? How?
10. What do you do ***day in and day out***?



Lesson 17

I CAN'T REMEMBER

Kevin was an accountant and worked in a small office downtown. However, over the years he began to forget things and that made his job a little difficult. One day he said to himself, "I'm going to see Dr. Russell about this." He waited patiently in the doctor's waiting-room with the other patients, and then the nurse said to him, "You can go in and see Dr. Russell now." Kevin hurried into the doctor's office, and the doctor said, "Please sit down, Kevin. What can I do for you?" "Oh, doctor," said Kevin, "it's terrible. I can't remember anything for longer than thirty seconds and it's making my work with numbers very difficult. What can I do? Can you help me?" The doctor said, "When did this start, Kevin?" "When… did what start?" Kevin asked.

What's the answer?

1. Who was Kevin?
2. What kind of problem was he having?
3. What did Kevin tell the doctor?
4. What was the doctor's first question?
5. What was Kevin's question?

USE IT

himself hurried patients longer

Lesson 18

WHERE'S MY CAKE?

Robby was nine years old. One day his friend Paul invited him to his birthday party. Robby asked his mother, and she said, "Sure, you can go, but don't forget to be polite and don't ask for cake and ice cream. Always wait for someone to offer you a piece of cake and some ice cream." "All right, Mom," Robby answered, and he went to Paul's house on his bicycle.

There were a lot of kids at the party. They played games and sang, "Happy Birthday" to Paul. Finally, Paul's mother started cutting the cake and giving it to all the kids. However, she forgot to give Robby a piece of cake. He waited politely for almost ten minutes, and then he held his plate up in the air and said loudly, "Does anyone want a nice clean plate?"

What's the answer?

1. What did Robby's mother tell him about the party?
2. What did his mother say about the cake and the ice cream?
3. What happened when Paul's mother started serving cake?
4. What did Robby do?
5. What did Robby say after about ten minutes?

USE IT

sure loudly polite nice

Lesson 19

LEARN IT

1. (to hold still)

Definition: to remain quiet, without moving.

Example: I told the children to hold still while they were at the wedding.

2. (to know by sight)

Definition: to recognize someone just by looking at them.

Example: Although I don't know your parents I will know them by sight.

3.*(something the matter)*

Definition: to have something wrong or not in order.

Example: Is there something the matter with your new car?

4. (to bring up)

Definition: to teach your children, to educate them from childhood.

Example: Where do you intend to bring up your children?

5. (to get lost)

Definition: to lose your direction or to become lost.

Example: How did you get lost if you have a map?

6. (to hold up)

Definition: to rob a bank, etc..., with a gun.

Example: He held up the bank on Friday and drove to Mexico.

7. (to run away)

Definition: to escape, to leave without notice or permission.

Example: Why did the little boy run away from home in June?

8. (to run errands)

Definition: to go to the store etc., to buy things or pay for others.

Example: When I need you to run an errand to the store you're never here.

9. (to see someone off)

Definition: to take someone to the airport and say good-bye.

Example: We're going to the airport to see Mike off.

10. (to set fire to)

Definition: to make something burn.

Example: The police are trying to find out who set fire to the house.

USE IT

1. Why is it so hard for children to ***hold still*** at church?

2. Do you remember your old friends from school ***by sight***?

3. Is there ***something the matter*** with your car or your parent's?

4. Where were you brought up and where would you like ***to bring up*** your kids?

5. Why do so many people ***get lost*** in big cities?

6. Have you ever seen someone ***hold up*** a bank?

7. Why do some young teenagers ***run away*** from home?

8. Who ***runs errands*** for you?

9. Who ***saw you off*** the last time you travelled? Where?

10. Have you ever ***set fire to*** anything?

Lesson 20

WHO'S GEORGE WASHINGTON?

Tony was eleven years old and he was in the sixth grade at Maple Elementary School. One day the teacher began asking some very easy questions to the students. She asked one student how many states there were in The United States. She asked another when Independence Day was. Now, Tony was a little shy and didn't like to answer questions in front of the other students. His teacher knew that and decided to ask him a very simple question. She said, "Tony, would you please tell the other students who the first president of The United States was?" Well, Tony wasn't really sure and answered, "I don't know." The teacher couldn't believe that he didn't know, and she asked him again. But Tony really didn't know.

Finally, Toni's teacher started losing her patience and asked Tony to come to the front of the classroom to answer the question. Once again she said, "Tony, for the last time, please tell the other students who the first president of The United States was!" Tony said, "I'm sorry, but I don't know." In desperation the teacher screamed, "GEORGE WASHINGTON!!!" Tony immediately returned to his seat. Now the teacher was even more upset and said, "Who asked you to return to your seat?" "Well," Tony said, "I thought you were calling another student named George!"

What's the answer?

1. Do you remember the first question the teacher asked?
2. Do you remember the question the teacher asked Tony?
3. Why was the teacher losing her patience?
4.Why did the teacher scream, "GEORGE WASHINGTON"?
5. Why did Tony return to his seat?

USE IT

grade losing shy desperation

Lesson 21

TOMMY IS FIGHTING AGAIN

Barbara was a typical American teenager who had a little brother. Her brother's name was Tommy. Tommy was ten years old and was always running, playing and getting into trouble. However, Barbara loved her little brother very much.

One afternoon while Barbara was walking home after school she saw Tommy running down the street. He was running very fast and Barbara was surprised and said, "Wait Tommy, where are you going in such a hurry!?" Tommy didn't stop but he waved to his sister and shouted, "I'm trying to stop a terrible fight between two boys!" Now, Barbara was very surprised because she knew that her brother Tommy was always fighting. Barbara said, "That's good! Who are the two boys?" "They're Billy and me." Immediately, Barbara looked and saw Billy running after Tommy.

What's the answer?

1. What kind of little boy was Tommy?
2. What did Barbara ask Tommy in the street?
3. What was little Tommy's answer?
4. Why was Barbara happy for a few seconds?
5. Why was Tommy running?

USE IT

typical waved trouble terrible

Lesson 22

LEARN IT

1. (to drive up to, to walk up to)

Definition: to approach walking or by car.

Example: After driving for about six hours we finally drove up to a gas station.

2. (to hand in)

Definition: to submit something that is due, to deliver it.

Example: All of the students must hand in their activity by Friday.

3. (to hold on)

Definition: to hold something very tight, to wait or pause.

Example: It's very windy outside so hold on to your hat.

4. (to think up)

Definition: to invent or to create an idea or something similar.

Example: I tried to think up a good excuse for being late to my English class.

5. (to be better off)

Definition: to be in a better situation or a better condition.

Example: In my opinion you would be better off in the country.

6. (to be well-off)

Definition: to be very rich.

Example: They have a very large house at the beach, and seem to be very well off.

7. (to keep in touch with)

Definition: to write or call someone, to continue communicating with someone.

Example: He promised to keep in touch with her while she was in Rio.

8. (to be named after)

Definition: to receive a name of a friend or relative at birth.

Example: Paul was named after his uncle who lives in San Francisco.

9. (to take apart)

Definition: to separate an object or some kind of mechanism.

Example: I think that it's easier to take a watch apart than to put it together.

10. (to take someone by surprise)

Definition: to surprise someone unexpectedly.

Example: His offer to buy my house took me completely by surprise.

USE IT

1. Why did you ***walk up to*** the teacher at the end of the class?
2. How many people in your class always ***hand in*** their activity on time?
3. What do you do while you're ***holding on*** the phone?
4. Opening a Checking Account using Internet is a great idea, who ***thought it up***?
5. Are you ***better off*** living in the city or in the country?
6. Do you know anybody that is very ***well off***? Who?
7. Who do you ***keep in touch*** with by phone?
8. Were you or anyone in your family ***named after*** one of your grandparents?
9. Do you know how ***to take apart*** a bike and then put it back together again?
10. Why did the neighbor's death ***take everyone by surprise***?

Lesson 23

TWO TRIPS

George loved to fly and after taking several lessons he became a very good pilot. In fact, over the years George became one of the best acrobatic pilots in the U.S. One day George invited his brother in law Joe to take a flight. Well, of course, Joe was a little afraid to fly with George because he knew that he was an acrobatic pilot, but he decided to go. Joe thought, "I've never been in a small plane before but I know that George is a respected pilot." They took off that day at 10:00 in the morning. George did all kinds of tricks for almost thirty minutes. Joe was silent during the flight. After landing, George looked at Joe, who was a little pale and said, "Well, what did you think about the flight and the tricks?" Joe immediately answered, "Thank you for the two trips in your plane." George was a little bit surprised and said, "Two trips?!" "Yes, my first and my last," answered Joe.

What's the answer?

1. Who was George?
2. Why was Joe afraid to fly with George?
3. Why was Joe so silent during the thirty minute flight?
4. Why was Joe so pale?
5. Why did Joe say, "Thanks for the two trips?"

USE IT

became took off been landing

Lesson 24

THE OLD INDIAN

John worked at Citibank in New York City. One day at work he read an article in the New York Times about an old Navajo Indian who lived on a reservation in Arizona. According to the article, the Indian was one hundred years old and had a fantastic memory. The article said that this Indian could remember historic facts about the U.S., the Civil War, past American presidents, etc. John thought to himself, "You know, I have a meeting scheduled for next week in Phoenix, Arizona, I'd like to visit that old Indian." Well, since John arrived a few days early in Arizona, he rented a car and drove to the reservation. When he arrived, he was surprised to find hundreds of people there waiting to visit the Indian and to test his memory. Finally, it was John's turn to ask the old Indian a question. John didn't have a specific question in mind so he asked the Indian if he could remember what he ate for breakfast fifty years ago on that day. The old Indian raised his head very slowly, looked at John and said, "I ate eggs, my son." Of course, John was very impressed and so were the others. After participating in the meeting and visiting the reservation, John returned to New York. Ten years later John was taking a walk in Central Park, when suddenly he couldn't believe his eyes. "It's impossible," he thought. "There's the Indian sitting on the bench, he was one hundred years old at that time." After a few minutes John approached the old Indian and said, "But. . . but how!?" The old Indian looked at John and said, "Fried!"

What's the answer?

1. What did John read one day in the New York Times?
2. Why was the Indian so famous?
3. What did John ask the Indian when he got to the reservation?
4. Why was John so surprised when he saw the Indian in Central Park?
5. What did John say when he spoke to the Indian in Central Park?

USE IT

according to approached impressed bench

Lesson 25

LEARN IT

1. (to get canned)

Definition: to be fired or dismissed.

Example: Unfortunately many workers got canned because of the lockdowns.

2. (to text (to) someone)

Definition: to write a message to someone from a smart phone, etc…

Example: When I get to Los Angeles I'll text you.

3. (to come across)

Definition: to find something or to encounter something unexpectedly.

Example: While I was cleaning the garage I came across an old photograph.

4. (to stand for)

Definition: to represent, usually referring to initials or an abbreviation.

Example: Can you tell me what I.B.M. stands for?

5. (to stand a chance)

Definition: to have the possibility or a chance to win or receive something.

Example: The team from New York doesn't stand a chance against Los Angeles.

6. (to make faces)

Definition: to make a strange or funny facial expression.

Example: Why do children like to make faces in the classroom?

7. (to look up to)

Definition: to admire somebody or to have a lot of respect for an individual.

Example: I really look up to my father for his courage.

8. (to look down on)

Definition: to have bad feelings or a bad opinion of others.

Example: Don't look down on them just because they are poor.

9. (to take time off)

Definition: to have free time or to be free from work or responsibilities.

Example: I'd like to take Friday off to go fishing with some friends.

10. (to go belly up)

Definition: to go bankrupt, to break (financially)

Example: Many businesses went belly up during the lockdowns.

USE IT

1. Will you text me when you get to New York?
2. Has the neighbor got canned?
3. How did the scientists ***come across*** the treasures in the pyramids?
4. What does F.B.I. ***stand for***?
5. Do you think a person ***stands a chance of winning*** a tennis match if he's out of shape?
6. Why do kids usually ***make faces***?
7. Who do you ***look up to***?
8. Why do some people ***look down on*** poor people?
9. When do you plan ***to take time off*** this year?
10. Do you know of any company that went belly up recently?

Lesson 26

DON'T SCREAM

One day a young boy was talking to his father and said, "Dad, I'd like to fly in an airplane some day!" His father, who was very tight with his money, looked at him and said, "Son, do you have any idea how much it costs to fly!? It's too expensive!" However, after a few days he finally persuaded his father to take him to the airport to talk to the pilots. When they arrived at the airport, the father said, "Son, let me talk to the pilots, because I don't have very much money and I want to talk to them about the price." Fortunately, they met a very nice pilot who agreed to take the father and son on a short trip. He also told the father and son that if they didn't scream or get scared during the flight, they wouldn't have to pay for the trip. In other words, if the father and son were completely silent during the trip, they wouldn't need to pay. The father liked the idea very much; after all, he didn't like to pay for anything. Eventually they took off; however, the pilot didn't tell them that he was an acrobatic pilot. When they landed, the pilot looked at the father and said, "Didn't you get scared? Didn't you feel like screaming?" The father finally opened his mouth and answered, "Well, just when my son fell out of the airplane but I resisted!"

What's the answer?

1. Why didn't the boy's father want to take his son to fly at first?
2. What was the agreement between the pilot and the boy's father?
3. Why was the pilot so surprised?
4. What was the pilot's question when they landed?
5. What did the father say to the pilot?

USE IT

tight eventually after all landed

Lesson 27

WHERE'S MY CHANGE?

Charley worked as a waiter in an expensive restaurant in San Francisco. One night a man sat down and ordered the most expensive meal and the most expensive wine on the menu. After finishing the meal, Charley gave him the bill. The man immediately looked at Charley and said, "I've already paid!" Surprised, Charley said, "I'm sorry Sir, but you haven't paid." The man continued to insist, "I've already paid!" Finally, the restaurant manager appeared. After listening to Charley's explanation, the manager asked the man to leave and never return. A few days later the same man appeared at the restaurant. He sat down at the same table and again ordered the most expensive food and wine on the menu. When Charley handed him the bill, he said, "I've already paid!" Once again, Charley called the manager and explained what was happening. The man continued to insist that he'd already paid. Again, the manager asked the man to leave and never return. One week later the same man returned again to the restaurant. He sat down at the same table and once again ordered the most expensive food and wine on the menu. The waiter sat down at a table near the man watching the man eat his meal and drink his wine. After a few minutes, the man asked the waiter, "What are you looking at?" Charley, the waiter answered, "Oh, I'm just watching." "Well," the man said, "I'm just waiting for my change and I don't want any problems this time."

What's the answer?

1. What did the customer order at the restaurant?
2. What did the man say to the waiter when he brought the bill?
3. What did the manager say to the man?
4. Why was the waiter sitting at the table watching the man?
5. What did the man say to the waiter when he was watching him?

USE IT:

ordered - handed - insist - few

Lesson 28

LEARN IT

1. (to knock out)

Definition: to hit somebody so hard that they fall and/or become unconscious.

Example: The rock hit him so hard that it knocked him out for a few minutes.

2. (to carry out)

Definition: to complete, accomplish or to finish something successfully.

Example: The plan was carried out successfully.

3. (to run into)

Definition: to meet somebody unexpectedly. (Also, to come across)

Example: I ran into an old friend at the bank yesterday.

4. (to drop in)

Definition: to visit a friend very briefly, a short unexpected visit.

Example: Drop in tonight after work if you have a minute.

5. (to drop out)

Definition: to leave or stop attending a school, club or organization.

Example: A lot of students dropped out last semester.

6. (to believe in)

Definition: to have faith in someone or something.

Example:I really believe that the kids believe in ghosts!

7. (to cheer up)

Definition: to make somebody happier.

Example: Everybody tried to cheer her up after she broke up with her boyfriend.

8. (to make sense)

Definition: to be reasonable, logical or to have a lot of common sense.

Example: To send more troops to Vietnam really didn't make sense.

9. (to break away)

Definition: to escape or become free.

Example: According to the news approximately five criminals broke away from the police.

10. (to blow away)

Definition: referring to a strong wind or breeze that carries something away. To really impress someone.

Example: The wind was blowing so hard that it blew the newspaper away.

USE IT

1. How long did it take Mike Tyson ***to knock out*** the other fighter?
2. Did you always ***carry out*** your parents orders?
3. Who did you ***run into*** this week?
4. Did you ***drop in*** on any relatives this week?
5. Why are so many teenagers ***dropping out*** of school nowadays?
6. Do you ***believe in*** love at first sight?
7. What's the best way ***to cheer up*** a person that's sad?
8. When the teacher explains something that doesn't ***make sense to you***, what do you do?
9. How do thieves usually ***break away*** from the police?
10. Her speech really blew me away!

Lesson 29

GIVE ME TWO

George was talking to his father about school, work and life in general. His father said, "Son, if you want to be successful in this world, you have to be very careful with the money you have. "For example, one day you will want to buy a new car, and if the salesman says, "This car costs $4,000.00," you have to say, "I will give you $2,000.00" If the salesman says, "This car costs $6,000.00," you have to say, "I will give you $3,000.00 for it." Well, George understood what his father was trying to teach him about life and money so one day he went to the Mall to buy a watch. When he got to the Mall, he immediately found the watch he was looking for. The salesman told him that the watch cost $110.00.

George looked at the salesman and said, "I will give you $55.00 for this watch." The salesman was surprised at his offer, and said, "For you, $80.00." George again looked at the salesman and said, "I will give you $40.00 for this watch." The salesman couldn't believe it, and said, "Obviously, you're in a very difficult financial situation. I'm going to give you this watch for free!" George smiled and said, "Give me two watches please!"

What's the answer?

1. What was the father teaching his son about life?
2. What did the father say to his son about buying and selling?
3. What did George say to the salesman when he said, "The price is $110.00"
4. Why did the salesman offer to give him the watch for free?
5. What did George say to the salesman when he said, "It's free?"

USE IT

general careful cost financial

Lesson 30

BUCKETS OF WATER

Bob, Tom and Ed were good friends that loved to go out at night; however, they didn't like to spend a lot of money. One night after going to the movies, they entered a small restaurant to buy hamburgers, fries and Coke. After eating, the waiter gave Tom the bill. Tom said, "Well, I'm certainly not going to pay!" and gave the bill to Bob, who said, "Well, I'm not going to pay either!" Bob then gave the bill to Ed, who said, "Neither am I." The waiter was a little confused and said, "I'm sorry, but all of you ate hamburgers and one of you has to pay." However, all three continued to insist that they wouldn't pay. Finally, the waiter said, "I've got an idea; I'm going to the kitchen to get three buckets of water. Each one of you will put your head in one of the buckets of water, and the first one that takes out his head will have to pay". Well, all three agreed and put their heads in the buckets of water, and all three drowned!

What's the answer?

1. What do you know about Tom and his friends?
2. What did the boys say to the waiter when he brought the bill?
3. What was the waiter's suggestion?
4. What did the waiter bring from the kitchen?
5. What happened to the three boys?

USE IT

certainly either confused agreed

Lesson 31

LEARN IT

1. (to get away)

Definition: to leave very quickly, to escape.

Example: In the summer we go to the beach to get away from the noise.

2. (to get away with)

Definition: to do something wrong or illegal without any punishment.

Example Unfortunately, many politicians get away with terrible crimes.

3. (to keep up)

Definition: to continue at the same speed or to maintain the same level of work, etc...

Example: If we keep up this speed we will arrive in Denver, Colorado on Friday morning.

4. (to make up)

Definition: to resolve or reconcile a problem, usually involving friends or couples.

Example: John and Mary made up last night at the party.

5. (to make up)

Definition: to create or invent a story or to say something that's not true.

Example: Why do fishermen make up stories?

6. (to stand out)

Definition: to be very easy to see or notice.

Example: She was so tall that she stood out in the classroom.

7. (to go wrong)

Definition: to fail or not go as planned.

Example: Something went wrong with our car and we couldn't start it.

8. (to serve a person right)

Definition: to receive a just or a fair punishment.

Example: It served him right to lose that job because he never worked hard.

9. (to let on)

Definition: to reveal information or to inform others.

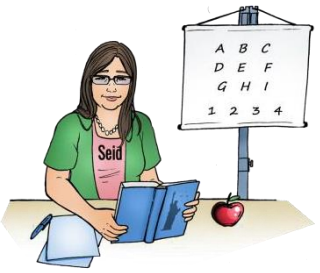
Example: Don't let on to Mary or Paula that Debra and I are going to the movies tonight.

10. (to meet halfway)

Definition: to compromise or to negotiate so that both can win.

Example:

Our suppliers will meet us halfway on the price.



USE IT

1. How did the dog ***get away***?
2. Did the thief ***get away with*** the crime?
3. Can a dog ***keep up*** with a cat?
4. What's the best way for a boyfriend and girlfriend ***to make up***?
5. What kind of story did the children ***make up*** about ghosts?
6. Why does that basketball player ***stand out*** in the city?
7. What ***went wrong*** with your car on your last vacation?
8. Do you believe that it ***served her right*** to lose her job?
9. Why did Paul's girlfriend tell Mary not ***to let on*** that they were going to the dance?
10. Will the salesman ***meet you halfway on the price*** or not?

Lesson 32

NOT A PENNEY MORE

Brian loved to go shopping and especially loved to buy clothes. One afternoon he walked into a store that had a sign outside: "We Buy and Sell Second Hand Clothes." Brian was holding an old pair of jeans and asked the store owner, "How much money will you give me for these old jeans?" The owner of the store quickly answered, "I will give you two dollars and not a Penney more!"

"What!?" said Brian. "I was sure they were worth at least five dollars." "No," said the owner, "Only two dollars and nothing more!" "Are you sure?" asked Brian. "I'm very sure," said the store owner. "Well," said Brian, taking the two dollars out of his pocket, "Here's your money. These pants were hanging outside your store with a price tag that said $5.50, but I thought that was too much money and I wanted to make sure." Then he left the store before the surprised store owner could think of anything to say.

What's the answer?

1. What did Brian like to do?
2. What was Brian holding when he went into the store?
3. What did the store owner say about the price of the pants?
4. What was the price of the pants according to the price tag?
5. What did the store owner think?

USE IT

especially second hand holding worth

Lesson 33

NO SMOKING PLEASE

Robert Hemming was a Stock Broker and the president of a large company in Salt Lake City. Like most businessmen he was always in a hurry and participated in meetings with his clients almost every week. He didn't smoke, however, many of his clients did.

One day after participating in a long meeting, his eyes were sore and he began coughing. Mr. Hemming decided to call one of the local air-conditioning companies to give him an estimate to improve the air-conditioning system in the meeting room. After a few days the air-conditioning company sent him a message with two estimates to choose from. Their first estimate was for $5,000.00 which included installing a complete new air-conditioning system in the office, and the other was for only $5.00 to buy a small sign which said: NO SMOKING!

What's the answer?

1. What was Robert's profession?
2. What was the problem in the meeting room?
3. What kind of estimates did Robert receive?
4. Why was the last estimate so cheap?
5. Why was Robert probably very happy about the estimate?

USE IT

Stock Broker hurry clients coughing

Lesson 34

LEARN IT

1. (to come about)

Definition: to happen, usually involving some time.

Example: How did the accident downtown come about?

2. (to build up)

Definition: to increase or to make something stronger.

Example: After being hospitalized for three months, John is trying to build up his energy.

3. (to bring about)

Definition: to cause something to happen or occur.

Example: The heavy spring rain brought about the flood last month.

4. (to die down)

Definition: to decrease slowly, to decrease in intensity.

Example: After you left, the party started to slowly die down.

5. (to die away)

Definition: to slowly or gradually diminish, usually referring to sounds, etc..

Example: The sound of the horn died away as she drove away.

6. (to die out)

Definition: to disappear gradually until it's completely gone.

Example: That kind of music died out many years ago.

7. (to make out)

Definition: to try to understand or decipher a message.

Example: Was it hard to make out her letter?

8. (to live up to)

Definition: to maintain a standard or to keep your word or promise.

Example: I bought a used car last year but the salesman didn't live up to his promises.

9. (to stand up for)

Definition: to defend or to support an idea or a cause.

Example: You must stand up for your rights.

10. (to stick to)

Definition: to adhere to something, referring to glue or a sticker, also to be constant.

Example: I don't know why the stamp won't stick to the envelope.

USE IT

1. How did the war in Iraqi ***come about***?

2. Why have so many countries stopped ***building up*** their armies?

3. What ***brought about*** the end of World War II?

4. What is the difference between ***to die down*** and to die away?

5. Why did the music slowly ***die away***?

6. What caused the fire ***to die out*** last night at the camp?

7. Is it easy ***to make out*** what the airplane pilot says on the microphone?

8. Why is it so important ***to live up to*** your promises?

9. When was the last time that you ***stood up for*** a friend?

10. Why didn't the stamp ***stick*** to the envelope?

Lesson 35

SEE YOU LATER ALLIGATOR

Steven was nine years old, and he was usually a very bad boy, but his parents always hoped that one day he would learn to behave himself. Then one day, after Steven came home from school, Steven's teacher called and said, "Did you know that your son Steven was a very brave little boy today at the zoo? Your son Steven saved Billy's life today when he fell into a lake full of alligators." Of course, Steven's mother was very happy when she heard this news. She thought, "Steven is finally becoming a good little boy." Then she turned and said to her son, "Steven, I'm so proud of you! Why didn't you tell me that you saved Billy's life today at the zoo?" Steven didn't look too happy when he heard that his teacher had called. His face turned red, and he said, "Well, I had to pull him out of that lake with the alligators because I was the one who pushed him in."

What's the answer?

1. What kind of little boy was Steven?
2. Why did Steven's teacher call his mother?
3. What did Steven's mother think about her son after hearing the news?
4. Why did Steven's face turn red?
5. What was Steven's explanation?

USE IT

behave brave becoming turned

Lesson 36

I REMEMBER YOU!

Mr. Taylor moved with his wife to Berkeley, California, and after a few weeks he needed to see a doctor. After finding a doctor in the yellow pages, Mr. Taylor wrote down the address and went to visit the doctor. When he sat down in the doctor's waiting room, he noticed the diplomas and degrees on the wall. Suddenly Mr. Taylor remembered that there had been a student in his high school class with the same name, and he had become a doctor. He went in to see the doctor, remembering a young, good looking student. However, he was a little bit surprised to see that the doctor was old, fat and had gray hair. Mr. Taylor said, "Good morning, Doctor. Did you go to West High School?" The doctor answered, "Yes, I did." "Were you there from 1955 to 1959?" Mr. Taylor asked. "Yes, I was," said the doctor. "How did you know?" Mr. Taylor laughed and said, "You were in my class!" "Oh?" the doctor said, looking at Mr. Taylor who was bald, "You were the teacher, right!?"

What's the answer?

1. What did Mr. Taylor remember when he saw the doctor's diplomas on the wall?
2. What did Mr. Taylor remember about that student from school?
3. Why was Mr. Taylor surprised when he saw the doctor?
4. What did Mr. Taylor ask the doctor?
5. What did the doctor ask Mr. Taylor?

USE IT

Moved noticed degrees gray

Lesson 37

LEARN IT

1. (to take down)

Definition: to remove from the wall or to disassemble an object.

Example: Who's going to take down the tent?

2. (to fall off)

Definition: to fall from someplace to the floor.

Example: Mike fell off his bicycle and broke his hand.

3. (to fall through)

Definition: to fail, to not work like you planned, different results.

Example: Our plans to go to the beach fell through because of the storm.

4. (to fall behind)

Definition: to be very slow, behind the others, progressing slowly.

Example: John fell behind at school because he works a lot.

5. (to give in)

Definition: to surrender, to stop trying or making an effort.

Example: After working on the project for almost a year he finally gave in.

6. (to give out)

Definition: to distribute, usually referring to papers or pamphlets.

Example: The teacher stood at the door giving out the test results.

7. (to hold off)

Definition: to wait until later or to delay, not right now.

Example: If the rain holds off for a few more days we will finish building the house.

8. (to turn over)

Definition: to place something upside down.

Example: The little boy turned over the turtle and it died.

9. (as usual)

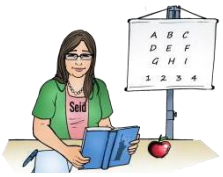
Definition: normal, nothing different.

Example: He went to the beach last Saturday, as usual.

10. (right there)

Definition: in that exact place, exactly where I said or planned.

Example: I intend to build a new house right there.



USE IT

1. Why did the maid ***take all the pictures down*** from the wall?

2. How did the vase ***fall off*** the table?

3. We planned the meeting for Friday morning at 8 o´clock, however, unfortunately it ***fell through*** and so?

4. Why do you suppose that so many people are ***falling behind*** on their payments?

5. He tried to negotiate the price but he finally ***gave in***. And now?

6. How many free tickets are they ***giving out*** at the movies?

7. Why did you decide ***to hold off*** on sending the products to Mexico?

8. Why did the maid ***turn the blanket over***?

9. Why was he late for class, ***as usual***?

10. Did you live ***right there*** near the beach?

Lesson 38

BAD GRADES

The University of Southern California had one of the best football teams in the country and its best player, Paul Smith was always having problems with his grades. Finally, the president of the university said that Paul would have to leave the college because of his bad grades. Immediately, the coach went to speak with the president about Paul's grades. The coach did everything possible to persuade the president to allow Paul to continue at the university and to play football. The president, however, showed the coach two answer papers. "This one is Susan's, she's the best student in the class." he said. "And this one is your football player's. "Well, they are exactly the same. Paul sat near Susan and copied all of her answers," the president explained. "Wait a minute!" the coach said. "Maybe Susan copied Paul's answers. You can't prove anything." "Look at this," the president said. "Susan didn't know the answer to question number 15, so she wrote, "I don't know." And your football player wrote, "Neither do I."

What's the answer?

1. What did the text tell you about Paul as a student and as an athlete?
2. What did the president decide?
3. Why did the coach go to see the president?
4. What did the president show the coach on the tests?
5. What did Susan and the football player write on question 15?

USE IT

grades persuade coach neither

Lesson 39

DON'T BOTHER ME

Mr. Young owned his own business and worked very hard. His wife was afraid that he would have a heart attack if he continued like that, so she tried to convince him to take a small vacation. At last she persuaded him to take one week off to go to the beach. However, she was still afraid that Mr. Young's secretary would bother him with messages, meetings and bills, so before traveling to the beach, Mrs. Young decided to drop by her husband's office. She said to his secretary, "Whatever happens, please don't bother my husband with texts, e-mails and bills while he is at the beach. Just wait until we get back." After two days at the beach, Mr. Young received a text from his secretary which said, "Something terrible has happened here at the office, but I'm not going to bother you with the details now while you're enjoying your vacation. So have fun and don't worry about anything!"

What's the answer?

1. Why was Mr. Young's wife so worried about her husband?
2. What did she convince him to do?
3. Why did Mr. Young's wife go to speak with her husband's secretary?
4. When did Mr. Young receive the text?
5. What did the text say?

USE IT

business convince persuade bother

Lesson 40

LEARN IT

1. (to let up)

Definition: usually referring to intensity, in this case less intensity.

Example: If the rain lets up a little bit, we will all go to the beach for the weekend.

2. (to lay off)

Definition: to fire or dismiss someone temporarily, usually because of slow business.

Example: Our Company usually lays off about 500 employees in the Summer.

3. (to bring out)

Definition: to produce or to present something, make it apparent.

Example: Ford always brings out its new cars in December.

4. (to bring back)

Definition: to return something to the place where you bought it.

Example: When are you going to bring back my calculator?

5. (to wait up for)

Definition: to wait for someone until very late without going to bed.

Example: Don't wait up for me, I'll be home before midnight.

6. (to let someone alone)

Definition: to stay away from someone or to permit them to be alone.

Example: If you let him alone for a few minutes he will probably go to sleep.

7. (to break off)

Definition: to finish or terminate.

Example: Diplomatic Relations were broken off between the two countries.

8. (to wear off)

Definition: to disappear very slowly or gradually.

Example: The medicine isn't very strong, I'm sure that it will wear off soon.

9. (to wear away)

Definition: to reduce or decrease gradually, usually referring to a certain period of time.

Example: The constant washing of the sea against the rocks, slowly wore them away.

10. (to read over)

Definition: to check very quickly.

Example: I read over the contract before signing it.

USE IT

1. What did he mean when he said the rain never ***"let up"*** in Miami?
2. Why did the factory ***lay off*** so many employees?
3. When does Chevrolet ***bring out*** its new model cars?
4. Why did he ***bring the shirt back*** to the store?
5. Why did the teenager tell his parent not ***to wait up for*** him?
6. Why did the teacher tell the children ***to let the monkey alone***?
7. Who decided ***to break*** off the engagement, you or her?
8. Will the paint on the walls ***wear off*** in a few years?
9. Are the pyramids in Egypt slowly ***wearing away***?
10. Why would you consider it a good idea ***to read over*** the contract first?

Lesson 41

WHICH WAY?

A small city near Santa Monica had a city dump where people could leave their old garbage. A lot of people loaded their garbage cans in the back of their cars and took them to the dump. One evening Mike filled his van with garbage and drove to the dump. He left his garbage there, when he noticed a young man arriving in a very old car, the young man turned around, drove backwards down the hill and then unloaded his garbage. While he was doing this, his car engine died. The young man tried to start his car several times, but his old car wouldn't start, so he said to the driver of the van: "Could you please give my car a push?" "Which way?" Mike asked.

What's the answer?

1. What kind of things do people take to the dump?
2. What did Mike notice when he was at the dump?
3. What happened to the young man's car?
4. What did the young man ask Mike?
5. Why was Mike so confused?

USE IT

dump loaded van backwards

Lesson 42

I FEEL FINE

Mr. Smith was retired. Over the years, Mr. Smith lived alone and became very lonely. He spent most of his time at home reading. He was also very careful about what he ate and drank, or going outside when the weather was cold. Mr. Smith was afraid he'd catch a terrible disease, so he visited his doctor a lot. Finally, the doctor became very tired of Mr. Smith's constant visits and his imagined illnesses. Then one day Mr. Smith hurried to the doctor's office and told him that he was sure he had a terrible disease which he had read about in the news. He showed the doctor the article. After reading the article, the doctor looked at Mr. Smith and said, "But, Mr. Smith, according to this article people never know when they have this disease! There are no symptoms, in fact, they feel very good!" "Oh no!" said Mr. Smith. "I knew it! That's how I feel!"

What's the answer?

1. What kind of person was Mr. Smith?
2. How did he spend most of his time?
3. Why was Mr. Smith so afraid to go outside?
4. What did Mr. Smith read in the news?
5. Why was the doctor surprised?

USE IT

retired disease article according to

Lesson 43

LEARN IT

1. (to work out)

Definition: to exercise or to be involved in some kind of physical activity.

Example: I like to work out in the morning before going to work.

2. (to back up)

Definition: to put the car in reverse, to drive backwards.

Example: The traffic was blocked on Maple Street and I was forced to back up and turn left.

3. (to back out)

Definition: to fail to keep your promise or your word.

Example: At the last minute I backed out and refused to participate.

4. (to be set)

Definition: ready or prepared to do something immediately.

Example: I was set to leave for the airport when he called me.

5. (to set forth)

Definition: to present or make something clear or apparent to everybody.

Example: He set forth all the rules to the game before starting to play.

6. (to buy up)

Definition: to consume everything there is, to buy all the stock.

Example: He loved the ice cream so much that he bought it all up.

7. (to buy out)

Definition: to buy a company or some kind of business from another person.

Example: He's been trying to buy out his partner for almost ten years.

8. (to sell out)

Definition: to sell completely, nothing is left.

Example: After one week all of the toys in the store were sold out.

9. (to catch on)

Definition: to understand something difficult or hard very quickly.

Example: The story was very funny, but when I told her she didn't catch on.

10. (to be cut out for)

Definition: to have the capacity or talent for a particular job.

Example: Peter found out after a few months at Medical School that he wasn't cut out for that.

USE IT

1. When was the last time that you ***worked out***?

2. Did you hit the car behind you when you ***backed up***?

3. Why did the businessman ***back out*** of the negotiations at the last minute?

4. What always happens when ***you're set*** to go on vacation?

5. Why is it a good idea ***to set forth*** the rules before you hire the secretary?

6. Why was everybody trying ***to buy up*** all the cheese at the supermarket?

7. Why is your partner interested in ***buying you out***?

8. How long did it take the store ***to sell out*** all the sugar?

9. In your opinion, why do some people ***catch on*** faster than others?

10. Do you believe that ***you're cut out*** for teaching?

Lesson 44

WHO'S ROBBING WHO?

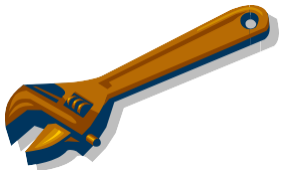
As usual, Mr. Benoit opened his jewelry store at 8:00 sharp on Friday morning. To his surprise, a thief entered the store quickly behind him, pointed a gun at him and demanded a watch. However, Mr. Benoit immediately put his hand on the store alarm to call the police. "Wait a minute!" the thief shouted, "please don't touch that button, I have a wife and four kids at home, I can pay for the watch!" Well, Mr. Benoit felt sorry for thief and didn't call the police, instead he accepted the thief's offer to buy the watch. When Mr. Benoit handed the thief the bill, he couldn't believe his eyes, and said, "Wow! $1,250.00 for a watch! I've changed my mind, you can push the alarm button to call the police, because now you are robbing me!"

What's the answer?

1. What happened one morning when Mr. Benoit opened his jewelry store?
2. What did Mr. Benoit do when the thief pointed a gun at him?
3. What did the thief say to Mr. Benoit about his family and about the watch?
4. Why was the thief so shocked when he saw the bill?
5. Why did the thief tell Mr. Benoit to push the alarm button to call the police?

USE IT

sharp gun shouted instead



Lesson 45

WHAT A WRENCH!

David had a new car. However, it was in the garage for repairs, so he borrowed his wife's old car to drive to work. In the morning he drove to the gas station to fill up the tank. Unfortunately, after filling up the tank, his wife's car wouldn't start. He thought there was probably something loose in the battery, so he took a wrench out of his trunk. When David hit the battery with the wrench, the car started. Then David noticed that there was something wrong with one of the headlights, so he hit the side of the car with the wrench, and the headlight immediately turned on. One of the mechanics watched carefully and said to David, "Listen! If you ever want to sell your old car, I don't want it, but I'd sure like to buy that wrench!"

What's the answer?

1. Why did David borrow his wife's car?
2. What happened after filling up the tank?
3. What did David do with the wrench?
4. What did David do when the headlight wouldn't work?
5. What did the mechanic say to David about his car and his wrench?

USE IT

repairs fill up loose sure

Lesson 46

LEARN IT

1. (to clear up)

Definition: to clarify or to make something easy to understand, clear.

Example: I'm sure that Mr. Smith will clear up this problem as soon as he gets here.

2. (to slow down)

Definition: to go very slow, to decrease your speed.

Example: I told him to slow down several times because of the rain.

3. (to dry up)

Definition: to completely dry.

Example: Every year in July the river dries up because of the lack of rain.

4. (to dry out)

Definition: to become dry over a period of time, like a wet towel outside.

Example: If you don't cover the sauce, it will eventually dry out.

5. (to be up to "something")

Definition: what someone is doing, planning or preparing.

Example: What do you think those kids are up to?

6. (to beat around the bush)

Definition: to speak a lot without being objective.

Example: Why don't you stop beating around the bush and say it!

7. (to come to an end)

Definition: to cease or terminate.

Example: The meeting finally came to an end at 4:00pm.

8. (to put an end to)

Definition: to cause something to end definitely, to terminate forever.

Example: We must put an end to these arguments.

9. (to get even with)

Definition: to retaliate, to get revenge.

Example: After stealing my book, I tried to get even by stealing his.

10. (to fool around)

Definition: to play games or joke with someone.

Example: He fools around all day long and never studies.

USE IT

1. What's the best way ***to clear up*** an argument?
2. Why did the traffic ***slow down*** at 5:00 p.m.?
3. What caused the river ***to dry up*** in June?
4. What's the fastest way ***to dry out*** your clothes?
5. What ***are you up to*** tonight?
6. Why are politicians always ***beating around the bush***?
7. How did the war in Iraqi ***come to an end***?
8. Who finally ***put an end to*** smoking in São Paulo?
9. What do people do to try ***to get even with*** others?
10. Did you ***fool around*** when you were in school?

Lesson 47

HAMBURGER

Mrs. Harris was a math teacher at a small elementary school. One morning while teaching her students fractions she asked Julie, "If I cut a piece of meat into two pieces what would I have?" "Halves," answered Julie. "Good," said the teacher with a smile on her face. "And if I cut each piece in half again?" "Fourths!" answered the next student. "And if I cut the meat again Lisa?" "Eighths," answered Lisa. "Yes, very good class. And again?" "Sixteenths,"was the answer. "Very good boys and girls." "And once more, Paul?" "Thirty- seconds," was Paul's answer, after thinking for a few seconds. "Yes, that's right!" At this point, Mrs. Harris was so impressed and happy that her students were learning so well. "And again!" she said to Robert. "Hamburger meat," answered Robert who was getting a little bit tired of her silly questions.

What's the answer?

1. What was Mrs. Harris teaching her students at school one day?
2. What was Paul's answer?
3. Why was Mrs. Harris so impressed and happy?
4. What was Robert's answer to her question?
5. What did Robert think about her questions?

USE IT

math pieces impressed silly

Lesson 48

TOO EXPENSIVE FOR TWO

Kevin worked in San Francisco. He was single and loved to eat out at nice restaurants. One evening while having dinner at one of his favorite restaurants, he saw a heavy man who was sitting at the table next to him. Kevin knew this man, but couldn't remember his name. Finally, he remembered his name and said, "Hello, Mr. Bullen. How's business?" "Oh, it's not very good," Mr. Bullen answered. Kevin looked at all the expensive food and wine on Mr. Bullen's table and said, "Well, it doesn't look like your business is doing badly." "I'm afraid you're wrong. You see, a few years ago, my business was very successful and I had enough money to bring my wife to this beautiful restaurant too."

What's the answer?

1. Who did Kevin see at the expensive restaurant in San Francisco?
2. What was Kevin's question?
3. Why was Mr. Bullen a little sad?
4. Why was Kevin confused by his answer?
5. What did Mr. Bullen say about his business a few years ago?

USE IT

favorite heavy I'm afraid enough

TEXT 1

The bus to Westlake was about to leave and Mrs. Greely was giving last-minute instructions to her six-year-old boy. “Call me the minute you get to Grandpa´s,” she was saying. She wished now she had not given in. It was a four-hour ride, and she was worried sick. As the bus pulled away, Robby waved and then pretended he was a spy. His mission was to follow the man sitting next to him to a secret meeting. “How far are you going?” the man asked. Robby told him he was going to his grandfather´s farm; he didn’t want to give away his mission! Robby and the man talked for a long time until the man said, "This is Hampton, I live here.” It was a rest stop and everybody got off. Robby kept out of sight and followed the man into the station. Robby watched the man approach a woman who was waiting by the door to the parking lot behind the bus station. Now Robby had all the information he needed, so he went back to the bus, but it was not there. As the man who had been on the bus drove out of the parking lot, he was surprised to see Robby standing in front of the station crying. He told Robby the bus had gone, but he and his wife would drive him to the Westlake bus station. At nine o´clock Mrs. Greely answered the phone and breathed a sigh of relief that Robby had arrived safely. "You see…?" the boy’s grandfather said, and she agreed it had been silly of her to worry.

Summary

1. Did Mrs. Greely put Robby on a bus or a train going to Westlake?
2. Was he going to his aunt´s house or his grandfather´s house? Was it a two-hour or a four-hour bus ride? *(and)*
3. Was Robby ten, or was he only six? Was his mother worried sick or not? *(Since Robby…)*
4. Who did Robby talk to on the bus?
5. Where did the bus make a stop? Did everybody get off for a few minutes or not? *(and)*
6. Did Robby get back on the bus, or did he miss the bus in Hampton? Did a man and his wife drive him to Westlake in their car or not? *(but)*
7. Would Mrs. Greely have been even more worried if she had known that Robby missed the bus in Hampton? *(If Mrs. Greely…)*

TEXT 2

It was years since I had visited my hometown and I was determined to enjoy my stay. I went to see my old friend Tom Clark who, along with his other responsibilities, was vice president of the civic association. At the time, Tom was busy making final arrangements for a distinguished writer to give a talk on modern literature at the public library. Since this was a subject that interested me, I gladly accepted Tom´s invitation to go with him. Tom was going to introduce the guest speaker that evening, so we went to the library a little bit early to greet him. Since he had not yet arrived. I left Tom and went into the main Reading Room where a large audience had already gathered. I was disappointed to find that I did not know a single person there. Just before the talk was due to begin, I saw Tom motioning to me from the doorway. He looked worried about something, so I got up immediately and went back to see him. He explained that he had just had a telephone call from the writer´s secretary. Our guest speaker had missed his flight and would not be arriving! While we were thinking about the problem, Tom suddenly asked me if I would mind filling in as speaker. I hardly had time to think about the matter when suddenly I found I was being led back into the Reading Room to address the waiting audience!

Summary

1. What old friend did you go to see when you returned to your hometown after many years absence? *(On returning…)*
2. Had Tom invited a famous artist or a distinguished writer to give a talk at the city library?
3. Did the subject interest you or not? Did he ask you to go with him or not? *(Since the subject)*
4. Who called that evening just before the talk began? Was the speaker going to be able to be there or not? *(That evening… to say that)*
5. Did Tom then suggest that you should address the audience or not? Where did he take you? *(and)*

TEXT 3

A man in Port Orchard by the name of Henry has a most unusual hobby. He likes planting flowers in strange places. When Spring comes around, you can always tell that Henry has been busy because the dirty sides of rivers, the banks along railroad tracks and land covered with trash suddenly come alive with flowers of all kinds. In his spare time, with pockets full of seeds, Henry goes riding around on his bicycle. He carries a long reed with him to blow seeds into spots that are hard to reach. When his flowers die, he goes around again collecting the seeds. In this way, he always has an ample supply. Many people make fun of Henry, but he never seems to let it bother him. Recently, I was having coffee with him and he told me that once he was planting seeds in a large vacant lot when the owner came along and sent him away. Henry returned some days later when there was no one around. You can imagine how surprised the owner was one day several months later when he saw a large letter "H" in flowers covering the entire lot! Henry took me to his house one time, and I was astonished to see that there was only one small flowerpot in the house. When I questioned him about this, he answered, "They´re not real. They're artificial. Real flowers should be out there where they belong." And he pointed out the window to his large flower garden.

Summary

1. What is Henry´s hobby?
2. Does he ride around on a bicycle in his spare time, or does he go around on foot? Why does he take a long reed with him? *(and)*
3. Do people sometimes make fun of him or not? Can they ever keep him from planting seeds on unused pieces of property? *(but)*
4. Does Henry have real flowers in his own house, or does he have artificial ones? What does he believe? *(Even though he loves flowers so much…because)*

TEXT 4

The whole family objected violently when I said that I was going to Europe over the Christmas holidays with a college friend of mine. Mother said that since there was going to be a family reunion; I really ought to stay at home. Although I always enjoyed these occasions, nothing could persuade me to change my mind. A week before Christmas, my friend and I flew to Madrid and then traveled by train through Spain, France and Germany. On Christmas Eve we arrived in a small town in southern Germany and were amazed to find so much activity in the town. The streets were crowded with people, and the shops were full of all kinds of interesting things. We walked around for hours and then just before midnight we went to listen to Christmas carols sung by children around the brightly lit tree in the main square. We returned to our hotel late that night, looking forward to the next day when we planned to have Christmas dinner at the best restaurant in town. However, in the morning the streets were deserted. To make matters worse, everything was closed up tight-even the restaurants. We searched in vain for hours and finally had to return to our hotel feeling unhappy and lonely. Our Christmas "feast" was a sack of fruit which my friend happened to buy the day before. Our thoughts sadly turned to home where, at that moment, our families must have been wishing us a "Merry Christmas."

Summary

1. Did your family want to stay home for Christmas or not? Where did you go? Who did you go with? *(In spite of the fact that…)*
2. Where were you on Christmas Eve?
3. Where did you go that night? Why? *(Just before midnight… to…)*
4. Where did you intend to eat the next day? Did you search for hours or not? Did you find everything closed or open? What did you do? *(but after searching… so…)*
5. What did you eat? How did you feel when you thought of your families? *(and)*

TEXT 5

As it came near the corner, the taxi stopped suddenly. The driver got out looking very puzzled. A big truck which had been following the taxi stopped too. The taxi driver was now standing at the corner looking up at the sky and the truck driver got out and joined him. A number of cars behind them were forced to stop as well and soon a large crowd of people had gathered at the corner. The cause of all this trouble was a very strange noise. It sounded as if thousands and thousands of birds were chirping. The sound of so many birds together was quite unnerving and many people looked frightened. The most extraordinary thing was that, apart from one or two pigeons, there was not a bird in sight. No one was able to solve the mystery-until two traffic patrolmen arrived on the scene. They walked all around the area for a while and then stopped over near the railroad tracks beside a billboard advertisement for a movie. Since the noise seemed to be coming from around there, they climbed up and found that two loudspeakers had been hidden behind the advertisement. The bird noises were being broadcast to attract attention to the movie advertisement. The advertising company was ordered to remove the loudspeakers, on the grounds that they were a public nuisance and that they created a serious traffic hazard.

Summary

1. Where did a large crowd gather after the traffic stopped?
2. Did everyone look puzzled or not? Could they hear thousands of birds or not? Were there many in sight? *(because… although there were hardly any)*
3. Who arrived on the scene? Did they trace the noise to an old railroad station or to a billboard? *(then…and)*
4. Did they climb up the billboard or not? Where was the noise coming from? Where were they hidden? *(After climbing… they found that… which…)*
5. What did the advertising company have to do? Was it a good advertisement for the movie or was it a public nuisance? *(because)*

TEXT 6

Dark black clouds in the sky meant one thing and one thing only: there was going to be a thunderstorm. Not one of us had brought an umbrella, or even a raincoat, so when Jack suggested that we go into the nearby museum, we all agreed immediately. Since we had been shopping all morning and were now feeling very tired, it would be a pleasure to sit down. We arrived at the entrance to the museum just as large drops of rain were beginning to fall. The museum was completely deserted and very peaceful. We sat down in the main hall and listened to the rain beating against the windows. Suddenly there was a big commotion out in the entry hall. Then a large group of schoolchildren came in, led by two teachers. The poor teachers were trying to keep them quiet and get them to behave, but they did not pay the slightest attention. The children ran here and there like wild animals. Apologizing for this lack of discipline, the teachers explained that the children were too excited to settle down. Eventually the noise proved too much for us and we decided to leave. As Jack remarked when we were back outside walking in the rain, the children had more right to be in the museum than we did. After all, they had come on an educational visit, while we had simply wanted to get in out of the rain.

Summary

1. Was there going to be a thunderstorm or not? Did you have umbrellas and raincoats with you? Where did you decide to go? *(and since)*
2. When did it begin raining?
3. Was it very quite in the main hall or not? Who came in? *(At first… until…)*
4. Who was in charge of them? Could they keep them in order or not? *(but)*
5. What did you prefer to do rather than put up with so much noise? *(Rather than…)*

TEXT 7

Old Sally Gibbs was a very strange woman. The beautiful house she lived in was surrounded by trees and lovely flower gardens. But she hardly ever went out. Although a housekeeper looked after her, her only real companions were two cats. For years she had refused to see any of her relatives because she felt that all they were interested in was her money. She was right about that. After her death, all of her relatives gathered at the house to hear Sally´s lawyer read her will. They were all sure that Sally had left a fortune and they each wanted a share. This led to violent arguments. In particular, they quarreled about the house. Sally´s nephew felt that it should go to him since he was the only one who used to visit his old aunt before she cut herself off from the family. Sally´s cousin objected to this, and soon there was heated argument in the living room while they waited for the lawyer to arrive. When the lawyer got there, the nephew said jokingly that supposed his aunt had left a big pile of debts. The lawyer did not even smile at this and asked them all to sit down. He began to read the will in solemn voice. Sally had been immensely rich-but she had left every penny of her fortune to her two cats!

Summary

1. Did Sally Gibbs want to see any of her relatives or not? Did she prefer to live with members of her family, or did she prefer to live alone with her two cats? *(preferring)*
2. Why did Sally´s relatives come to her house after her death?
3. Did they think she had left them a great deal of money or not? Did they quarrel violently among themselves just before the lawyer arrived at the house or not? *(Thinking that…)*
4. What did they discover when the will was read? *(However)*

TEXT 8

An old friend from California, who was going to spend a few days with me, called from the airport to tell me that he had arrived. I was not able to leave the office, but I had made plans for his arrival. After explaining where my new house was, I told him that I had left the key under the doormat. Since I knew it would be pretty late before I could get home, I suggested that he make himself at home and help himself to anything that was in the refrigerator. Two hours later my friend phoned me from the house. At the moment, he said, he was listening to some of my records after having had a delicious meal. He had found the skillet and fried two eggs, and had helped himself to some cold chicken in the refrigerator. Now, he said he was drinking a glass of orange juice and he hoped I would join him soon. When I asked him if he had any difficulty finding the house, he answered that the only problem was that he had not been able to find the key under the doormat, but fortunately, the living room window by the apple tree had been left open and he had climbed in through the window. I listened to all this in astonishment. There is no apple tree outside my window, but there is one by the living room window of my next-door neighbor´s house.

Summary

1. Where were you when your friend arrived from California? Did you tell him how to get to your house or not? *(so)*
2. Where did you tell him the key was? Did you suggest that he make himself at home or not? *(and)*
3. Who phoned some time later? Had he had a delicious meal or not? *(…to say that…)*
4. Was the key under the doormat or not? Had he climbed in through the living room window by the apple tree, or had he gone in trough the kitchen door? *(Since the key…)*
5. How did you feel when you heard this? Whose house had your friend accidentally entered? *(because)*

TEXT 9

It had been a tiring day and I was looking forward to a quiet evening. My husband would not be back until late and I had decided to settle down in a comfortable chair in the living room and read a good book. I put the children to bed early and fixed a sandwich and a cup of coffee. Soon I was settled comfortably with my book in front of me and the sandwich and cup of coffee on a tray beside me. I was beginning to eat when the telephone rang. I dropped my book and hurried to answer it. By the time I got back to the living room, my coffee was cold. I ate the sandwich and began sipping cold coffee with the book still open to the first page. Suddenly there was a loud knock at the front door. It startled me so much that I spilled some coffee on my skirt. The man at the door was looking for a certain address and wanted me to give him directions. It took me a long time to get rid of him. After that, I sat down again and managed to read a whole page without further interruption-until the baby woke up. He started screaming at the top of his lungs so I rushed upstairs. He was still awake at 11 o´clock when my husband came home. I could have thrown something at him when he asked me if I had spent a pleasant evening!

Summary

1. What did the writer fix after she put the children to bed? *(After putting…)*
2. Was her husband going to be home early or late? How did she intend to spend the evening? *(Since her husband…)*
3. What happened just as she was beginning to eat?
4. Did she have time to sit down again or not? Who knocked at the door? *(She had hardly… when…)*
5. Did she begin reading when he left or not? Why did she have to stop? *(but… because…)*
6. What did her husband ask her when he got home at 11 o´clock? Was she happy, or did she feel like throwing something at him? *(on returning…)*

TEXT 10

The elderly woman behind the wheel now regretted that she had stopped to pick up the two young hitchhikers. As they hurriedly loaded their backpacks into the car, the young man turned and shouted, “Come on, Sam!” Almost immediately a huge, long-haired dog that had been lying beside the road got up, shook himself violently, and them came lumbering toward the car. Two other dogs, a beagle and a mangy- looking cocker spaniel, followed a few feet behind. The woman gasped when she saw the monstrous animals approaching. She wondered why she had not noticed the dogs when she first caught sight of the young couple thumbing a ride. There was nothing she could do about it now, she told herself. She certainly could not bring herself to tell them that the dogs could not ride in her car. Instead she forced a polite smile and asked, “Is there going to be enough room for you in the back seat?” That was a mistake, as she quickly realized, and she was sorry that she had brought the subject up. “It´s going to be a little crowded,” the young girl said, “ but Sam can ride in the front seat with you if that´s all right.” As they started off, both dogs in the back seat were barking and clawing at the windows. The woman glanced nervously at Sam who by this time was sprawled out comfortably on the seat beside her, panting loudly. Then and there she made a secret vow to herself about hitchhikers.

Summary

1. What did a woman see on the highway? Did she have plenty of room or not? What did she decided to do? *(Driving…and since…)*
2. Did the hitchhikers load their backpacks into the car, or did they leave them by the side of road? Did they call to their dogs or not? Were the dogs hiding under the car, or were they sleeping nearby?
3. Did the woman find out they were traveling alone or that they had three dogs with them? Was she glad she had decided to give them a ride, or was she sorry?
4. Were two of the dogs put in the back seat or not? Was there plenty of room? Did the big dog have to ride in front, or was there enough room in the back seat for all three dogs? *(but since)*
5. Did the woman park the car, or did she drive off? Did the woman vow to herself that next time she would drive a bigger car or that she would never stop for hitchhikers again? *(vowing)*

TEXT 11

As the small twin-engine plane passed over the airport, everyone aboard sensed that something was wrong. The plane was bouncing around violently, and although the passengers had fastened their seat belts, they did not feel very secure. At that moment, the door to the pilot´s compartment swung open, and the passenger nearest the door stared into the cockpit in disbelief. The pilot was slumped over in his seat and his right arm was dangling loosely at his side. Turning to the other five passengers and speaking quickly but almost in whisper, he informed them that something had happened to the pilot and asked if anybody knew anything about flying a plane. No one replied, but after a moment´s hesitation a young boy sitting at the back got up and came forward. The passenger by the door helped the boy move the pilot´s body aside, and then the boy slid into the pilot´s seat. He listened to instructions from the airport control tower and talked back and forth with the controller. The boy circled the airport several times, following instructions from the tower on how to move the controls. However, the danger had not yet passed. The terrible moment came when he had to begin the landing. Guiding the plane toward the runway, he lowered it closer and closer to the ground. As it touched down, the plane shook violently and then zigzagged down the long runway until finally it came to a stop. Outside, rescue teams who had been waiting anxiously, rushed toward the plane to congratulate the thirteen-year-old “pilot” on his successful landing.

TEXT 12

We were about to gather up our picnic things and return to our car when a man appeared. He looked very annoyed and asked us angrily if we realized that we were on private property. My father looked very confused, and the man then pointed to a sign which said that picnicking and camping were strictly forbidden. Poor father explained that he had not seen the sign and did not realize that it was a private property. Although my father apologized, the man did not seem satisfied and asked him for his name and address. All the way home, we were so upset that hardly anyone said a word. This unpleasant experience had spoiled a wonderful day in the country. All during that week, we wondered what would happen. We stayed at home the following Sunday, even though it was a beautiful day. About noon, a big limousine pulled up in front of our house. We were astonished when we saw several people getting ready to have a picnic in our front yard. My father got very angry and went out to ask them what they thought they were doing. You can imagine his surprise when he recognized the man who had taken down our name and address the week before! Both men burst out laughing, and my father welcomed the strangers into our house. Eventually, we became good friends – but all of us learned a lesson we have never forgotten.

TEXT 13

We were losing the battle. Our King was old and weak and could hardly move. He was hiding just outside the castle walls. Of the three soldiers who had been appointed to protect him, two had been killed while on duty, and I was left alone. From where I was standing, I had a good view of the battle. Fortunately for us, our Queen was young and active. Tall, dark, and very beautiful, she looked splendid out there on the battlefield with her knights at her side. She had fought with great courage and had already destroyed two enemy officers herself. Since we had lost so many men, it was difficult for her to attack. She therefore decided to do all she could to defend the King. I was shocked when I saw a lowly enemy soldier threatening her! He came up very close, but her brave knights sacrificed themselves to save her. Alone now, she was trapped by the enemy, and although she fought hard, she too lost her life. Great numbers of enemy officers and soldiers now descended upon us and soon destroyed the castle. Completely defeated, the king and I tried to run away together, but it was too late. As the King moved up behind me, I heard someone shout, “Checkmate!”

The chess game was over.

TEXT 14

It was very hot in the small courtroom and everybody was feeling sleepy. After a tiring, morning, the clerks were anxious to get off for lunch, and even the judge must have felt relieved when the last case came up before the court. A short, middle-aged man with gray hair and small blues eyes was now standing before him. The man had a peculiar look on his face and he kept looking around the courtroom as if he was trying very hard to figure out what was going on. The man was accused of breaking into a house and stealing an inexpensive wristwatch. The witness who was called did not give a very clear account of what had happened. He claimed to have seen a man outside the house at night, but on being questioned further, he confessed that he was not sure whether this was the man or not. The judge considered the matter for a short time and then declared that since there was no real proof, the man could not be found guilty of any crime. He said that the case was dismissed and then rose to go. Meanwhile, the defendant looked very puzzled. It was clear from the expression on his face that he had not understood a thing. Noticing this, the judge paused for a moment and then the man looked at the judge and said “Excuse me, your honor, but do I have to give the watch back or not?”

TEXT 15

The fact that everybody enjoys a good mystery explains why magicians are such popular entertainers. We all know that a magician does not really depend on “magic” to perform his tricks, but rather, on his ability to act with great speed. However, this does not prevent us from enjoying a magician who can produce rabbits from a hat, swallow countless eggs or saw his wife in two. Probably the greatest magician of all time was Harry Houdini. He died in 1926. His real name was Ehrich Weiss, but he adopted the name “Houdini” after reading a book which influenced him greatly. The book was written by a famous magician called Robert Houdini. Houdini mastered the art of escaping. He could free himself from the tightest knots or the most complicated locks in just seconds. Although no one really knows how he did these things, there is no doubt that he had made a close study of every type of lock ever invented. Strapped to his leg, he carried a small needlelike tool made of steel, and it is believed that he used this tool in place of a key. Houdini once asked the Chicago police to lock him up in a prison. They bound him in chains and locked him up, but he freed himself in an instant. The police accused him of having used some kind of tool, and they locked him up again. This time he wore no clothes and there were chains around his neck, waist, wrists and legs; but he again escaped in a few minutes. The usual explanation is that Houdini had probably hidden his “needle” in a wax like substance and dropped it on the floor somewhere in a passageway. As he went past it, he could have stepped on it so that it would stick to the bottom of his foot. Houdini´s most famous escape, however, was altogether astonishing. He was heavily chained and enclosed in an empty wooden chest-the lid of which was nailed. The chest was then dropped into the water in New York Harbor. One minute later, Houdini returned to the surface. When the chest was brought up, it was opened and the chains were found inside.

TEXT 16

Martin Thompson's funeral was a quiet affair. It was attended by the only relatives he had in the world, his niece and nephew, and by a few friends. Marty had led a hard life looking for gold in a remote part of Alaska. He often declared that one day he would find a nugget of gold as big as his head and then retire and live in comfort the rest of his life, but his dreams of great wealth never came true. However, a curious thing happened to him in the last weeks of his life, and although no one knew it, Marty died a contented man. He was digging post holes one day when his shovel struck something hard. Finding a large stone, he got down on his hands and knees and managed to unearth it. It shone curiously in the sunlight. As he stared at the stone, it dawned on him what it was – a large gold nugget! Tears streamed down his face as he realized that his lifelong dream had come true. Still on the ground, he sat motionless for a few minutes. It was as though a great burden had been lifted from him. Breathing a deep sigh, he deposited the nugget back in the ground and covered up the hole. With the shovel over his shoulder and grinning broadly, he walked back to his cabin.

TEXT 17

On my last day in Grants Pass, I decided to visit Wildlife Safari, an animal preserve near Roseburg. Leaving my hotel, I found my way to Interstate Highway 5 and headed north. After entering the preserve area, I stopped from time to time to take photographs of different animals. A little later, I was delighted when I saw a sign saying: "Caution: Lions. Stay in your car." I had no intention of getting out, of course. I had been driving through a wooded area and just then came to a shallow stream. I started driving across the stream and was about halfway when the rear wheels began to spin; the car was stuck in the mud! Complaining about my bad luck, I looked around very carefully. There was not a lion in sight. I was soon in the stream getting completely soaked, but there was nothing I could do about moving the car. My first impulse was to leave the car and start walking, but I did not relish the idea of starting out on foot through the woods. Remembering the warning about the lions, I got back into the car safety. I felt miserable and I wondered how long it would be before I was discovered by wild beasts. I could imagine elephants charging at me, or lions deciding that I would make a tasty meal! I was greatly relieved when, about two hours later, an attendant drove up in a jeep and soon hauled my car out of the stream. It took me some time to recover from this experience, and I decided after that to confine my visits to zoos.

TEXT 18

This year I decided to do something to regain my reputation as a good uncle. My nephew, Tommy, had never forgiven me for the dictionary I had bought him as a birthday present last year. His parents had no reason to be grateful to me either, because the year before, I had presented their dear son with a jar of paste, some funny pictures and a scrapbook. Instead of pasting the pictures in the scrapbook, Tommy had naturally covered every wall in the house with them. This year, therefore, I decided to let him choose for himself. We went into a big toy store but Tony found something wrong with everything he saw. I showed him toy after toy, but to no avail; he saw nothing he liked. Then suddenly I saw his eyes light up. He had discovered something he really did want: a large tin drum. I was quite pleased too-until I thought about what Tommy´s mother would say when she saw it. Nobody would get any sleep for weeks! I led Tommy away quickly, saying that the drum was too expensive. If that was how I felt, Tommy replied jokingly, then I could buy him the big model train set in the store window. Now that was really expensive, so I quickly changed the subject. Tommy asked if he could around by himself for a while, and I made the most of my opportunity to sit down and rest my aching feet. Fifteen minutes passed but there was still no sign of Tommy. I wondered where he was and got up to look for him. I asked a young lady if she had seen a little boy in jeans and a T-shirt. She looked about her helplessly and pointed out that there were so many little boys in jeans. I was beginning to get worried when I saw an odd figure dressed in strange purple clothes. It was Tommy, of course. He was wearing a false beard and had a caveman´s axe in one hand, and a space gun in the other. He informed me that he was the first caveman to fly in space.

TEXT 19

The four famous rock stars were due to arrive at any moment and a large crowd of young people had gathered at the airport to welcome them. The police found it very difficult to keep the crowd under control after the plane landed and the performers appeared. They smiled and waved cheerfully at everybody Dressed in pink shirts and light blue trousers, and with their long hair and their musical instruments over their shoulders; the four young men looked remarkably alike. In spite of the large number of policemen present, it was clear that the group would not be able to get to their waiting car easily. Word had gotten out that they had composed a new song which would be heard when they performed at the auditorium that evening. They were now greeted with cries of "Play something! Play your new song!" Even the police looked pleased when the young men unstrapped their instruments and prepared to do one of their numbers as the price for getting out of the airport. The crowd settled down and listened to the first performance of the new song. As soon as it was over, there was a great burst of applause and then everyone started stamping and shouting. Several young women fainted and had to be carried away by the rescue unit which was standing by. Greedy for more, the crowd demanded a repeat performance. Once again the performers yielded, but when the crowd requested still another song, the group cheerfully but firmly refused. Now, closely surrounded by the police, they put away their instruments and started towards their car which was some distance away. The crowd pushed forward, but policemen, locked arm in arm, prevented anyone from getting through. It took the singers a long time to reach their car. Finally, however, they got in and were just about to drive away when a young woman, who had somehow managed to get past the police, jumped onto the roof of the car. She shouted loudly as two policemen dragged her away and the car began moving slowly through the cheering crowd.

TEXT 20

Homer, the great blind poet of ancient Greece, wrote a long account of the Trojan War in the lliad. People had long been interested in finding the city of Troy, but the only man who took Homer´s description seriously was Heinrich Schliemann. Using Homer as his guide, Schliemann discovered what was almost certainly the ancient city of Troy. Though he had made it his aim to find Troy as a young man, Schliemann was only able to realize his ambition after he had amassed a large fortune and retired from business. Schliemann at once realized that the spot in Asia Minor generally believed to be Troy did not match Homer´s detailed description. According to Homer, a palace of sixty rooms had been built on a hill, and the Greeks had marched between their ships and the city several times a day. The hill on which Troy was supposed to have been built was not only very small, but was a great distance from the sea as well. Much nearer the sea, Schliemann came across a bigger hill. Homer had written that Achilles and Hector had run around the walls of Troy three times while fighting each other. Having calculated that this would have been possible, Schliemann decided to dig. It was not long before he discovered the remains of a city-not Troy, but a much later one called New llium. When his workmen dug deeper, Schliemann was most surprised to find that there were no less than nine cities built on top of each other. But which of these was Troy? Homer again provided Schliemann with two important facts: the city had been built of stone and had been burned to the ground by the conquering Greeks. Schliemann believed that the second city must have been Troy, for he found the ruins of a palace and a large gate blackened by fire. Yet the most astonishing discovery was still to come. After noticing something shining in the soil, Schliemann got so excited that he dug with his bare hands. He unearthed the beautifully preserved treasure of King Priam: gold, silver and jewelry, thus completing one of the most important historical discoveries ever made.